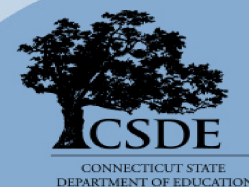


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



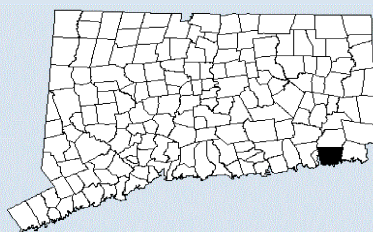
Groton School District

Ms. Susan Austin, Superintendent • 860-572-2100 • <https://www.grotonschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	4,113
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$18,359
Total Expenditures ¹	\$82,010,034

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,970	47.9	48.5
Male	2,137	52.0	51.5
Non-Binary	6	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	30	0.7	0.3
Asian	263	6.4	5.1
Black or African American	295	7.2	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	992	24.1	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	19	0.5	0.1
Two or More Races	466	11.3	4.3
White	2,048	49.8	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	168	4.1	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,907	46.4	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	778	18.9	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	562	28.5	205	8.9
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	88	33.2	56	17.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	345	36.8	101	9.4
White	437	23.2	105	4.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	58	33.3	10	5.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	646	38.2	230	11.1
Students with Disabilities	257	38.4	102	11.1
District	1,088	28.4	319	7.2
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 1,313

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	283.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	69.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	62.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	188.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	8.0
School Level	25.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.5
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	30.4
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	34.9
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	257.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.2	0.1
Asian	7	1.5	1.3
Black or African American	18	4.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	10	2.2	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.2
White	419	91.9	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.0	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	11	*	11	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	37	77.1	33	67.3
White	98	86.0	122	82.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	6	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	75	83.3	51	65.4
Students with Disabilities	27	73.0	20	43.5
District	182	83.5	202	76.5
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	47	41.2
Emotional Disturbance	23	39.0
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	228	86.4
Other Health Impairment	83	66.4
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	72	94.7
District	463	66.0
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	125	2.9	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	59	1.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	34	0.8	0.6
Learning Disability	264	6.2	6.1
Other Health Impairment	125	2.9	3.3
Other Disabilities	75	1.8	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	87	2.1	1.9
All Disabilities	769	18.1	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	55	7.2	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	23	3.0	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$48,072,427	\$10,762	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$11,143,758	\$2,754	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$1,950,563	\$482	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$1,986,024	\$491	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$4,741,671	\$1,172	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$1,658,032	\$410	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$7,155,842	\$1,769	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$5,301,716	\$1,595	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$170
Total	\$82,010,034	\$18,359	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$8,075,670	38.3	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,771,267	13.1	10.8
Other Salaries	\$1,036,253	4.9	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$1,898,914	9.0	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,531,511	7.3	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$3,884,787	18.4	22.6
Supplies	\$163,635	0.8	0.6
Property Services	\$1,118	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,698,822	8.1	6.3
Equipment	\$23,987	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$2,450	0.0	0.1
Total	\$21,088,412	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.7	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	63.8
State	32.4
Federal	3.8
Tuition & Other	0.0

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	14	*	14	*	*	*
Asian	110	75.5	110	72.0	48	68.8
Black or African American	114	55.7	114	48.3	47	46.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	448	58.9	448	51.7	198	55.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	9	*	9	*	*	*
Two or More Races	218	63.7	217	57.0	91	60.6
White	952	70.3	950	63.7	386	65.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	110	55.3	110	51.1	39	49.1
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,755	66.7	1,752	60.0	741	62.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	863	59.7	859	53.3	357	55.0
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,002	71.6	1,003	64.7	423	66.7
Students with Disabilities	335	46.2	335	40.0	127	41.4
Students without Disabilities	1,530	70.4	1,527	63.7	653	65.2
High Needs	1,031	58.8	1,028	52.6	415	54.1
Non-High Needs	834	75.1	834	67.9	365	69.5
District	1,865	66.1	1,862	59.4	780	61.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	81.6	74.0	79.6	84.8	1,032	79.7
Curl Up	72.8	70.7	79.3	81.7	1,032	75.7
Push Up	64.3	67.8	76.1	63.9	1,032	68.4
Mile Run/PACER	80.2	41.8	46.7	51.8	1,032	55.5
All Tests - District	51.9	27.8	36.8	48.2	1,032	40.7
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	28	92.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	53	77.4
White	128	85.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	130	80.0
Students with Disabilities	49	65.3
District	250	85.6
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	113	50.9
Male	93.1	116	44.8
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	90.6	9	28.1
Hispanic or Latino	91.8	29	29.9
White	95.0	149	56.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	85.0	6	30.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	92.3	55	32.7
Students with Disabilities	77.1	*	*
District	93.6	229	47.5
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2022 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	67.6	87.2
Male	48.6	81.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	44.4	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	39.0	70.0
White	65.2	85.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	44.5	81.8
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	58.1	84.6
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	66.1	75	44.0	50	88.1	64.2
	High Needs Students	58.8	75	39.2	50	78.3	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	59.4	75	39.6	50	79.3	58.6
	High Needs Students	52.6	75	35.1	50	70.1	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	61.3	75	40.9	50	81.7	61.4
	High Needs Students	54.1	75	36.1	50	72.1	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	63.0%	100%	63.0	100	63.0	60.4%
	High Needs Students	59.3%	100%	59.3	100	59.3	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	70.4%	100%	70.4	100	70.4	65.2%
	High Needs Students	68.1%	100%	68.1	100	68.1	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	70.0%	100%	35.0	50	70.0	64.9%
	Oral	58.9%	100%	29.4	50	58.9	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	28.4%	<=5%	3.3	50	6.6	23.7%
	High Needs Students	36.6%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	79.7%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	47.5%	75%	31.7	50	63.3	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		88.2%	94%	46.9	50	93.8	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		85.6%	94%	91.1	100	91.1	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		80.0%	94%	85.1	100	85.1	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		58.1%	75%	77.5	100	77.5	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		90.5% 40.7%	75%	27.1	50	54.3	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		57.9%	60%	48.3	50	96.5	52.4%
Accountability Index				1021.0	1450	70.4	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.8	16.2	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.9	52.6	15.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	69.5	54.1	15.4	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	80.0%	14.0%	10.2%	Y

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.0
	High Needs Students	96.9
Math	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	96.6
Science	All Students	96.6
	High Needs Students	94.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 48.6

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Groton Public Schools realized the Groton 2020 plan with the opening of one new middle school, Groton Middle School, ensuring excellence, equity, and balance for all middle school students 2020-2021. As part of the plan with the state of Connecticut that would ensure racial and socioeconomic balance at all Groton schools, this plan also included the building of two new elementary schools on the sites of the former two middle schools. The six elementary schools prepared and planned for an all intra-district magnet option for students in Groton with the rollout of a lottery process and preparation to move relocate students and staff from the six schools into five. This past September 2021, we opened our two new elementary schools, while closing three vintage elementary school and creating an all intra-district elementary magnet program, for all five elementary schools in Groton.

Groton Public Schools continues to focus on quality instruction and student achievement, which are inherent in our district mission and goals. As a PK-12 school system, we use engaging inquiry-based instruction and a variety of formative and summative assessments as part of our yearly assessment calendar to inform curriculum and instruction aligned with the CSDE. The scheduled SBAC assessments, the NGSS, and the eleventh grade SAT exams were given in the spring of 2021, however due to the pandemic, students in Groton had options for Hybrid or Remote Learning, with a few who participated in full in-person learning. All ninth and tenth graders take the PSAT exam; those results are used to inform instruction.

Groton Public Schools has grown teacher leadership in the areas of 6-12 Coordinators in ELA, Humanities, STEM and Special Education. At the elementary level, each school has both a literacy and math specialist. These specialists provide teacher coaching and coordinate instruction as well as provide intervention and enrichment to students. The district has also implemented this specialist model at the middle school level.

In the area of special education, the district continued its co-teaching model at both the middle and high school levels. The district continues to use the inclusion model at all grade levels and has continued its Intensive Behavioral Support Programs at the elementary, middle and high school levels. The district's post-graduate Transition Academy is currently located at a renovated facility in the Central Office. Groton Public Schools continued its partnership with Columbia's Teacher College Reading and Writing Project, utilizing the Remote Units of study with Videos from staff TCRWP staff developers in grades K-8.

In addition, the teachers continue to work with distinguished math consultant, Dr. Cathy Fosnot, on inquiry-based math workshop.

A continued focus on culture and climate, especially in the nearly two years of a pandemic, was at the heart of all we do in our schools. In addition, the district continues to implement restorative justice practices at all levels. We have several district committees to cultivate greater systemic coherence. To that end, our District Safe School Climate and Wellness Committees assisted the district with realizing positive school climate as evidenced in our student, parent, and staff surveys.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Groton schools continues to work to ensure that our students receive an education which enables them to interact with teachers and students from diverse racial, ethnic, and economic backgrounds. The district has recently completed a major curricular initiative; the district applied for and was approved for a candidacy for the International Baccalaureate Middle Years Program in grades 6-10. This initiative is aimed at significantly expanding enrollment in the International Baccalaureate programs offered by the district, both the IB Diploma Program and IB Careers Program. The program ensures excellence and equity and promotes college and career readiness.

In the spring of 2020, the Groton Board of Education responded to the social unrest caused by the killing of George Floyd by initiating a district-wide Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee. The 100-person group developed a five-year program to address issues of systemic racism and to promote equity for all members of the educational community. During the 2020-2021 school year, over one hundred teachers and administrators participated in the district DEI Committee that was responsible for planning a facilitating professional learning, book clubs, data collection, policy review, and the lifting of student voice. All faculty and staff were involved in the experience and the BOE recognized and approved the DEI vision statement for Groton Public Schools. We now have this initiative in our operating budget with a stipend position for a DEI coordinator, that was hired in 2021 " 2022. The work has continued on this year with action steps towards understanding racial bias in schools, improving hiring of diverse candidates, reading, discussing, and implementing models from Culturally Responsive Teaching and the Brain by Zaretta Hammond.

In Groton Public Schools, where 49% of the students are eligible for free and reduced lunch, all students were provided a school nutrition program, and the district implemented a one-to-one Chromebook initiative, with hotspots as needed, to provide computer access for all students.

Fitch High School students participated remotely in a regional diversity program called More Than Words designed to promote respect for diversity and develop skills in conflict resolution.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Groton School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Groton Board of Education's policy concerning the annual distribution of resources ensures that each of the eight schools in the district receives an adequate level of material, supplies, and personnel to implement and execute educational programs. Funding is based on student enrollment, district-wide educational programs, and the unique needs of its students, commensurate with district goals and available resources to ensure equity and address needs. Over the past seven years, Groton Public Schools has been awarded numerous competitive Federal grants, received approximately 5 million dollars from Department of Defense Education Activity grants (DoDEA) for technology, literacy, math, STEM-science, STEM careers and nearly another 4 million dollars from Federal Magnet School Assistance Programs (MSAP). Both the DoDEA math grant K-12 and the MSAP grant for middle school closed out at the end of this year, with sustainability built in to both grants to continue the initiatives.